ii. *He's the bafflement of Scotland Yard, the Flying Squad's despair: For when they reach the scene of crime — Macavity's not there!..*

a) What is 'Scotland Yard'?

b) Why does the flying squad feel disappointed?

iii. *He sways his head from side to side, with movements like a snake; And when you think he's half asleep, he's always wide awake…*

a) Explain the comparison made here.

b) What does he pretend to do?

iv. *For he's a fiend in feline shape, a monster of depravity.*

a) How is the cat described in this line?

b) Explain the phrase 'monster of depravity'.

v. *And his footprints are not found in any file of Scotland Yard's.*

a) What seems to be a challenge for the Scotland Yard?

b) Why do they need his footprints?

vi. '*It must have been Macavity!' but he's a mile away.*

a) What is Macavity blamed for?

b) Where is he?

vii. *There never was a Cat of such deceitfulness and suavity.*

a) Which cat is being talked of here?

b) How is he different from the rest?

E. Explain the following lines with reference to the context.

i. *His powers of levitation would make a fakir stare*

ii. *And when you think he's half asleep, he's always wide awake*

iii. *And his footprints are not found in any file of Scotland Yard's*

iv. *There may be a scrap of paper in the hall or on the stair*

But it's useless to investigate…

v. *He always has an alibi, and one or two to spare*

F. Eliot has used many figures of speech to present the poem to the readers in an interesting way. He has attributed human qualities to a cat in this poem.

i. Identify the literary devices used in the following lines:

a. He sways his head from side to side, with movements like a snake.

b. They say he cheats at cards.

ii. Give four instances where the poet has used alliteration in the poem.

iii. What is the rhyme scheme used in the poem?

iv. Pick out all the pairs of rhyming words used in the poem.

G. Listening Activity

Limericks: Poetry is of different forms and types. One among them is the Limerick. Limerick is a light, humorous verse form of five lines. The lines 1, 2 and 5 are of three feet and lines 3 and 4 are of two feet following the rhyme scheme **aabba**.

04-B-Poem-Macavity - The Mystery Cat.indd 130 11-12-2021 14:58:44